

Somdeepa Das

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Pronouns: She/Her/Hers

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Applied Microeconomics, Labor Economics, Public Economics

EDUCATION

Purdue University Daniels School of Business, West Lafayette, IN

PhD in Economics

Expected 2027

Committee Chair: Jillian Carr

Jawaharlal Nehru University, New Delhi, India

MPhil in Economics

2022

Dissertation: “Democracy of the Divided: Political Polarization on Twitter in West Bengal”

MA in Economics

2019

Jadavpur University, Kolkata, India

BA in Economics

2017

RESEARCH

JOB MARKET PAPER

Science under collective bargaining: How unionization shapes academic labor markets and research productivity [[Slides](#)]
with Jian Qi Tan

Studies how faculty and graduate-student unionization changes sorting, employment, wages, and research productivity in U.S. academic labor markets. Uses staggered union recognition and contract ratification across public and private universities, together with legislative timing as an instrument for union exposure.

WORKING PAPERS

Does easier access to alcohol affect road safety? Evidence from Texas Municipal Elections [[Paper](#)]

Under review at Journal of Public Economics

with Tong Li

Uses close local option elections in Texas to study how expanded alcohol access affects traffic safety. Legalization increases liquor licenses, driven almost entirely by off-premise retailers, and shifts sales toward retail outlets without increasing total crashes, DUI crashes, or fatal crashes.

WORKS IN PROGRESS

Legalized Sports Betting and College Performance

with Jillian B. Carr, Zachary Knepper, and Matthew Kovach

Estimates the causal effect of legalized sports betting on student academic performance and engagement using quasi-random variation in exposure to live sporting events generated by individual fandom and course schedules of college students.

PRESENTATIONS

ASSA Annual Meeting, Washington, DC	2027 (upcoming)
SEA Annual Meeting, Houston, TX	2026 (upcoming)
MEA Annual Meeting, Chicago, IL	2026
APPAM Fall Research Conference, Seattle, WA	2025
MEA Annual Meeting, Kansas City, MO	2025

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor, Purdue University

Intermediate Microeconomic Theory (Undergraduate)	Fall 2025
Principles of Microeconomics (Undergraduate)	Spring 2025
Principles of Microeconomics (Online, Undergraduate)	Summer 2024

Teaching Assistant, Purdue University

Economics and Public Policy (Masters)	Fall 2023, 2024
International Trade (Undergraduate)	Fall 2022, 2023, 2024
Principles of Microeconomics (Undergraduate)	Fall 2022, Spring 2023

PRIOR RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

LEAD at Krea University, New Delhi, India

<i>Research Consultant</i>	Feb 2022 – Jun 2022
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Jawaharlal Nehru University, New Delhi, India

<i>Field Research Assistant</i>	Apr 2019 – Sep 2019
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FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS

Daniels School Outstanding Teaching Certificate	2025
EXIM Bank Scholarship, Jawaharlal Nehru University	2019
UGC Junior Research Fellowship, Government of India	2018

SERVICE

Social and Diversity Officer, Business Doctoral Students Association, Purdue University	2023–2025
Member, Student Faculty Council, Jawaharlal Nehru University	2018–2019

SOFTWARE

R, Stata, Python, Matlab

LANGUAGES

Bengali (Native), English (Fluent), Hindi (Advanced)

REFERENCES

Jillian Carr

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Daniels School of Business
Purdue University
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Kevin Mumford

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Tim Bond

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Tim Moore

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